

Requirements Analysis and Question Generation

Car Rental Section - New York

Reference site: <https://www.booking.com/cars/index.html>

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Date: May 14, 2026

Document Type	Requirements Analysis Report
Domain	Online Car Rental Booking
Target Page	booking.com/cars/index.html
Geographic Scope	New York, USA (pickup/return)
Methodology	Agile BA - Characteristics of Good Requirements
Stories Analyzed	8 User Stories
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1. Introduction

This document presents a structured requirements analysis of the car rental section on Booking.com, focused on the New York market. The analysis assesses candidate user stories against the recognised Characteristics of Good Requirements (clarity, testability, feasibility, necessity, consistency, completeness, atomicity, traceability, prioritisation and understandability) and produces clarification questions for stakeholders. Each question is accompanied by non-directive answer examples in parentheses to guide format without prescribing an answer.

1.1 Scope

The scope covers the end-to-end booking flow that an end user experiences on the public Booking.com car rental pages when pickup or drop-off is set to a New York location (e.g. JFK, LGA, EWR, Manhattan downtown). It includes search, filtering, vehicle comparison, booking, payment and post-booking management.

1.2 Methodology

Each user story is reviewed for compliance with the Characteristics of Good Requirements. Where issues are identified, targeted clarification questions are generated. Suggested answer formats are provided in parentheses; they are intentionally neutral and non-directive.

2. User Stories Analysis

The following section contains the requirements analysis for each user story identified for the car rental section in New York. The output for each story is presented inside a script block, in line with the analysis template.

2.1 Story 1 - Search for available cars

```
```markdown
User Story:
As a traveler visiting New York, I want to search for available rental cars in
New York, so that I can find a suitable vehicle for my trip.

Issues Found:
- Pickup location is not specified (NYC has multiple airports and many city
branches). The story is not atomic regarding location.
- No mention of pickup/drop-off date and time.
- "Available" is not defined (real-time availability, cached, supplier-driven?).
- No criteria for "suitable" (size, transmission, budget).
- Drop-off location is not stated (same as pickup or one-way).
- No prioritisation, business value, or success metric.
- Edge cases (no results, partial availability, sold-out dates) are not covered.

Clarification Questions:
- Q1: Which pickup locations in New York must be supported in the first
release? (JFK Airport, LaGuardia, Newark EWR, Manhattan downtown, all
Booking.com NY branches, or other)
- Q2: Should the user be able to choose a different drop-off location?
(same as pickup only, any NY location, any US location, international,
or other)
- Q3: What is the minimum and maximum rental duration the user can search
for? (in hours/days, e.g., 1-30 days, 4-90 days, other)
- Q4: What time granularity is supported for pickup and return?
(15 min, 30 min, 1 hour, or other)
- Q5: How should "no cars available" be handled?
(empty state with suggestion of nearby dates/locations, recommended
alternative city, waitlist, or other)
- Q6: What is the expected maximum response time for the search results?
(in seconds, e.g., < 2 s, 2-5 s, other)
- Q7: How should the system handle local NY tax and surcharges in the
displayed price? (included in price, shown separately, toggle, other)
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2.2 Story 2 - Filter and sort results

```
```markdown
User Story:
As a user, I want to filter and sort the list of New York rental cars,
so that I can quickly find the best option for me.

Issues Found:
- Not atomic: filtering and sorting are two distinct capabilities.
- "Best option" is vague and not testable.
- No list of filter/sort attributes.
- No specification of default sort order.
- "Quickly" is not measurable.
- No information about combining multiple filters and persistence.
```
```

Clarification Questions:

- Q1: Which filter attributes must be supported?
(price range, supplier, car class, transmission, fuel type, seats, air-conditioning, electric/hybrid, mileage policy, free cancellation, or other)
- Q2: Which sorting options should be available?
(recommended, price low-high, price high-low, customer rating, supplier rating, distance from pickup point, or other)
- Q3: What is the default sort order on first load?
(recommended, lowest price, highest rated, or other)
- Q4: Should selected filters persist between searches and sessions?
(current session only, persistent per user, until cleared, or other)
- Q5: What is the expected reaction time after a filter change?
(instant client-side, < 1 s server round-trip, with skeleton loader, or other)
- Q6: How should the empty state look when filters return zero results?
(message only, suggestion to relax filters, auto-relax, or other)

2.3 Story 3 - View car details

```markdown

#### User Story:

As a user, I want to view full details of a New York rental car, so that I can make an informed decision.

#### Issues Found:

- "Full details" is unbounded and not testable.
- No mention of which data fields are mandatory.
- No mention of images, similar/alternative offers, or supplier reputation.
- No mention of how price breakdown is displayed.
- No information about availability of details in multiple languages or currencies.
- Accessibility requirements are not addressed.

#### Clarification Questions:

- Q1: Which information fields are mandatory on the car details page?  
(model, class, seats, doors, luggage, transmission, fuel, A/C, mileage policy, deposit, included extras, or other)
- Q2: How should the price breakdown be shown?  
(single total, day rate + taxes + fees, expandable breakdown, or other)
- Q3: How many photos per vehicle must be displayed and from which source?  
(1, 3, 5+ images; supplier-provided, generic class image, mixed, or other)
- Q4: Should the page show supplier rating and review snippets?  
(overall score only, score + categories, score + textual reviews, or other)
- Q5: Which currencies and languages must be supported on the details page for New York?  
(USD only, USD + EUR + GBP, auto by IP, user-selected, or other)
- Q6: Which accessibility (WCAG) level must the page meet?  
(WCAG 2.1 AA, 2.2 AA, AAA, or other)

## 2.4 Story 4 - Add extras and insurance

```markdown

User Story:

As a user, I want to add extras and insurance to my New York car rental, so that my trip is more comfortable and safer.

Issues Found:

- Not atomic: extras (child seat, GPS) and insurance are different product domains with different legal/regulatory implications in New York.
- No list of extras or insurance products.
- No definition of pricing model (per day vs flat).
- "Safer" is subjective and not testable.
- No info on age- or licence-related restrictions specific to NY/USA.
- No info on whether insurance is mandatory.

Clarification Questions:

- Q1: Which extras must be available for selection?
(additional driver, child seat, infant seat, booster, GPS, snow chains, ski rack, Wi-Fi hotspot, or other)
- Q2: Which insurance products must be offered?
(Collision Damage Waiver, Theft Protection, Full Coverage, Personal Accident, Roadside Assistance, or other)
- Q3: How is the price for extras calculated?
(per day, per rental, tiered by duration, included free, or other)
- Q4: How should mandatory NY/USA legal items be handled?
(auto-included with notice, opt-out allowed, blocked from removal, or other)
- Q5: Are there driver age restrictions or young/senior driver fees in NY that must be enforced at the extras step?
(under 25, under 21, over 70, none, or other)
- Q6: Should the user see a clear summary of what each insurance covers and excludes?
(tooltip, modal, side panel, downloadable PDF, or other)

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## 2.5 Story 5 - Compare cars side by side

```markdown

User Story:

As a user, I want to compare several rental cars in New York, so that I can choose the right one.

Issues Found:

- Maximum number of cars to compare is not stated.
- No definition of the attributes shown in the comparison view.
- No mention of saving or sharing the comparison.
- "Right one" is not measurable.
- No info about behaviour on mobile (limited width).
- Accessibility is not addressed.

Clarification Questions:

- Q1: How many cars can the user compare at the same time?
(up to 2, 3, 4, unlimited, or other)
- Q2: Which attributes must be present in the comparison table?
(price total, day rate, class, seats, transmission, fuel, mileage policy, deposit, supplier rating, cancellation policy, or other)
- Q3: Should the comparison be shareable or downloadable?
(shareable link, PDF/email, screenshot only, none, or other)
- Q4: How should comparison behave on mobile devices?

(horizontal scroll, accordion, swipeable cards, disabled below a breakpoint, or other)

- Q5: Should compared items persist across sessions for logged-in users? (session only, 24 h, until cleared by user, or other)

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2.6 Story 6 - Book and pay

```markdown  
User Story:  
As a user, I want to book a New York rental car and pay online,  
so that my reservation is confirmed.

Issues Found:

- Not atomic: booking and payment are separable concerns.
- Payment methods are not specified (especially for US market - cards, ApplePay, GooglePay, PayPal).
- No mention of 3-D Secure / SCA equivalent.
- No mention of guest checkout vs registered user.
- No mention of deposit hold on credit card (typical in US car rental).
- No detail on confirmation channels.
- "Confirmed" is not defined (instant vs supplier-confirmed).
- No info on currency handling.

Clarification Questions:

- Q1: Which payment methods must be supported for New York pickup? (Visa, Mastercard, Amex, Discover, ApplePay, GooglePay, PayPal, or other)
- Q2: Is guest checkout allowed or must the user have an account? (guest allowed, account required, optional account creation at end, or other)
- Q3: How is the credit card deposit hold communicated to the user? (informational text, explicit checkbox, separate confirmation screen, or other)
- Q4: What is the confirmation flow after successful payment? (instant on-screen + email, email only, SMS + email, push notification, or other)
- Q5: Which currencies can the user pay in? (USD only, USD + home currency with FX disclaimer, multi-currency, or other)
- Q6: How long should the system wait for supplier confirmation before treating the booking as failed? (immediate, < 30 s, async with email follow-up, or other)
- Q7: What is the rollback behaviour if payment succeeds but supplier confirmation fails? (auto-refund, manual support workflow, retry, or other)

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## 2.7 Story 7 - Modify or cancel a booking

```markdown  
User Story:
As a user, I want to modify or cancel my New York car rental booking,
so that I can adapt my plans.

Issues Found:

- Not atomic: modification and cancellation are different flows with

different business rules.

- No definition of which fields are modifiable.
- No mention of cancellation deadlines or fees.
- No mention of refund timing and method.
- No mention of supplier vs Booking.com side rules.
- Edge cases (no-show, partial refund) are not addressed.

Clarification Questions:

- Q1: Which fields of an existing booking can be modified online?
(dates, times, pickup/drop-off location, driver name, extras, all, or other)
- Q2: What is the cancellation policy window?
(free up to 48 h before pickup, 24 h, 1 h, non-refundable, supplier-defined, or other)
- Q3: How are cancellation fees calculated?
(flat amount, % of total, tiered by time-to-pickup, or other)
- Q4: To which method are refunds returned?
(original payment method, store credit, voucher, choice of methods, or other)
- Q5: How long should a refund take to be issued?
(immediate, 1-3 days, 5-10 business days, or other)
- Q6: How should no-shows in NY be handled?
(no refund, partial refund, supplier-defined, or other)
- Q7: How is the user notified about modification/cancellation status?
(email, SMS, push, in-app, all, or other)

```

## 2.8 Story 8 - Driver requirements and documents

```markdown

User Story:

As a user, I want to know the driver requirements and documents needed for picking up the car in New York, so that I avoid problems at the counter.

Issues Found:

- Not testable: "knowing" is not a measurable system behaviour.
- No mention of which documents are required.
- No definition of when this information must be shown (search, details, checkout, confirmation, all).
- No mention of international driver permit, age, credit card requirement specific to the US/NY market.
- No mention of localisation of requirements (e.g., requirements differ for non-US residents).
- "Problems at the counter" is subjective.

Clarification Questions:

- Q1: At which point(s) of the journey must driver requirements be shown?
(search results card, details page, checkout, confirmation email, all, or other)
- Q2: Which documents must be listed for a New York pickup?
(driving licence, passport, international driving permit, credit card in driver's name, proof of address, or other)
- Q3: What is the minimum and maximum driver age policy?
(21-75, 25-70, supplier-defined, or other)
- Q4: Is a credit card in the main driver's name mandatory?
(always, only above a price threshold, only for specific car classes,

or other)

- Q5: Should requirements be tailored to the user's country of residence?
(yes, dynamically by profile/IP; no, generic; toggle by user, or other)

- Q6: Should the user be required to confirm they have read these requirements before payment?

(mandatory checkbox, informational only, none, or other)

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3. Summary of Findings

Across the 8 analysed user stories, the recurring weaknesses are: lack of atomicity (multiple capabilities bundled together), use of vague qualifiers such as "quickly", "best", "suitable" and "full", absence of measurable performance targets, missing edge-case coverage (empty states, supplier confirmation failures, no-shows) and missing local New York / USA specifics (credit card deposit, age-based fees, taxes and surcharges, driver documents). The clarification questions above are the minimum required to bring these stories to a state where they can enter sprint planning.

3.1 Recommended Next Steps

- Schedule a clarification workshop with Product, Legal and the New York supplier-management team to answer the questions above.
- Split bundled stories (e.g. "book and pay", "modify or cancel") into atomic stories with clear acceptance criteria.
- Add explicit, measurable non-functional requirements (performance, accessibility WCAG 2.1 AA, supported browsers and devices).
- Create a glossary covering New York specifics (deposit, surcharges, driver age fees, IDP requirements).
- Define the source of truth for availability and pricing and the SLA for supplier confirmation.

Confirm if further adjustments are needed.